GOOD GOVERNANCE: CONCEPTS AND FRAMEWORKS

THREE TERMS, ONE TEST → MEASUREMENT LAYER AGAINST NORMATIVE → THE SIX NAMED DIMENSIONS → GOOD GOVERNANCE INDEX EDITION → WHAT MAY NOT BE → ATTRIBUTION DISCIPLINE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA ● APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g3 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00 STAGE 00 — THREE TERMS, ONE TEST

THREE TERMS, ONE TEST · LEGISLATURE, EXECUTIVE, JUDICIARY; THE FORMAL AUTHORITY-HOLDERS · STATE PLUS MARKET PLUS CIVIL SOCIETY MAKING AND ENFORCING · GOOD GOVERNANCE · THE NORMATIVE STANDARD APPLIED TO THE SECOND; NOT A · ANSWER MOVE · NAME THE DUTY-HOLDER AND THE BINDING FORM BEFORE EVALUATING · MUST REMEMBER

CORE CLAIM
- GOVERNMENT → legislature, executive, judiciary; the formal authority-holders
- GOVERNANCE → state plus market plus civil society making and enforcing collective decisions

MECHANISM
- GOOD GOVERNANCE → the normative standard applied to the second, not a synonym for the first
- ANSWER MOVE → name the duty-holder and the binding form before evaluating performance

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- MUST REMEMBER: Good governance converts legitimate public authority into rights-...
- GOVERNMENT → legislature, executive, judiciary; the formal authority-holders

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MUST REMEMBER: Good governance converts legitimate public authority into rights-.

01 STAGE 01 — MEASUREMENT LAYER AGAINST NORMATIVE LAYER

MEASUREMENT LAYER AGAINST NORMATIVE LAYER · WORLDWIDE GOVERNANCE INDICATORS, SIX DIMENSIONS, AGGREGATED PERCEPTION · GOOD GOVERNANCE INDEX, TEN SECTORS, STATE AND UNION-TERRITORY DIAGNOSTIC · UNDP PRINCIPLES AS A PROCESS CHECKLIST THAT CANNOT RANK · SECOND ADMINISTRATIVE REFORMS COMMISSION INSTITUTIONAL-REFORM FRAME

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
MEASUREMENT → Worldwide Governance Indicators, six dimensions, aggregated perception	NORMATIVE → UNDP principles as a process checklist that cannot rank	MEASUREMENT → Worldwide Governance Indicators, six dimensions, aggregated perception
MEASUREMENT → Good Governance Index, ten sectors, state and union-territory diagnostic	NORMATIVE → Second Administrative Reforms Commission institutional-reform frame	MEASUREMENT → Good Governance Index, ten sectors, state and union-territory diagnostic

CORE CLAIM
- MEASUREMENT → Worldwide Governance Indicators, six dimensions, aggregated perception
- MEASUREMENT → Good Governance Index, ten sectors, state and union-territory diagnostic

MECHANISM
- NORMATIVE → UNDP principles as a process checklist that cannot rank
- NORMATIVE → Second Administrative Reforms Commission institutional-reform frame

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- MEASUREMENT → Worldwide Governance Indicators, six dimensions, aggregated perception
- MEASUREMENT → Good Governance Index, ten sectors, state and union-territory diagnostic

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: NORMATIVE → Second Administrative Reforms Commission institutional-reform frame.

02 STAGE 02 — THE SIX NAMED DIMENSIONS

THE SIX NAMED DIMENSIONS · VOICE AND ACCOUNTABILITY · POLITICAL STABILITY AND ABSENCE OF VIOLENCE · GOVERNMENT EFFECTIVENESS · REGULATORY QUALITY · RULE OF LAW · CONTROL OF CORRUPTION · SCORED SEPARATELY, PERCEPTION-BASED, REPORTED WITH A MARGIN OF ERROR

VOICE AND ACCOUNTABILITY → POLITICAL STABILITY AND ABSENCE OF VIOLENCE → GOVERNMENT EFFECTIVENESS → REGULATORY QUALITY → RULE OF LAW

CORE CLAIM
- VOICE AND ACCOUNTABILITY
- POLITICAL STABILITY AND ABSENCE OF VIOLENCE
- GOVERNMENT EFFECTIVENESS

MECHANISM
- REGULATORY QUALITY
- RULE OF LAW
- CONTROL OF CORRUPTION

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- CAUTION → scored separately, perception-based, reported with a margin of error

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CAUTION → scored separately, perception-based, reported with a margin of error.

03 STAGE 03 — GOOD GOVERNANCE INDEX EDITION CARD

GOOD GOVERNANCE INDEX EDITION CARD · 25 DECEMBER 2019 BY THE DEPARTMENT OF ADMINISTRATIVE REFORMS · LATEST LOCATED NATIONAL EDITION · GOOD GOVERNANCE INDEX 2020-21, RELEASED 25 DECEMBER 2021 · THREE GROUPS IN 2019; FOUR IN 2020-21 INCLUDING NORTH-EAST · THE CLAIM OF A 2025 NATIONAL EDITION, CORRECTED ON

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
LAUNCH → 25 December 2019 by the Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances	GROUPING → three groups in 2019; four in 2020-21 including North-East and Hill States	LAUNCH → 25 December 2019 by the Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances
LATEST LOCATED NATIONAL EDITION → Good Governance Index 2020-21, released 25 December 2021	WITHDRAWN → the claim of a 2025 national edition, corrected on 13 August 2026	LATEST LOCATED NATIONAL EDITION → Good Governance Index 2020-21, released 25 December 2021

CORE CLAIM
- LAUNCH → 25 December 2019 by the Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances
- LATEST LOCATED NATIONAL EDITION → Good Governance Index 2020-21, released 25 December 2021

MECHANISM
- GROUPING → three groups in 2019; four in 2020-21 including North-East and Hill States
- WITHDRAWN → the claim of a 2025 national edition, corrected on 13 August 2026

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- LAUNCH → 25 December 2019 by the Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances
- LATEST LOCATED NATIONAL EDITION → Good Governance Index 2020-21, released 25 December 2021

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: WITHDRAWN → the claim of a 2025 national edition, corrected on 13 August 2026.

04 STAGE 04 — WHAT MAY NOT BE ASSERTED

WHAT MAY NOT BE ASSERTED · LAUNCH DATE, LOCATED EDITION, EDITION-SPECIFIC GROUPING, GOOD GOVERNANCE DAY · A RANK ONLY WITH ITS EDITION YEAR ATTACHED · ANY POST-2021 NATIONAL EDITION, RANK, SCORE, INDICATOR COUNT OR · THE DISTRICT GOOD GOVERNANCE INDEX TREATED AS A NATIONAL

SAFE → launch date, located edition, edition-specific grouping, Good Governance Day since 2014

BOUNDED → a rank only with its edition year attached → PROHIBITED → any post-2021 national edition, rank, score, indicator count or top performer → PROHIBITED → the District Good Governance Index treated as a national edition

CORE CLAIM
- SAFE → launch date, located edition, edition-specific grouping, Good Governance Day since 2014
- BOUNDED → a rank only with its edition year attached

MECHANISM
- PROHIBITED → any post-2021 national edition, rank, score, indicator count or top performer
- PROHIBITED → the District Good Governance Index treated as a national edition

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- SAFE → launch date, located edition, edition-specific grouping, Good Governance Day since 2014
- BOUNDED → a rank only with its edition year attached

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: PROHIBITED → the District Good Governance Index treated as a national edition.

05 STAGE 05 — ATTRIBUTION DISCIPLINE

ATTRIBUTION DISCIPLINE · WORLD BANK · WORLDWIDE GOVERNANCE INDICATORS, SIX DIMENSIONS, CROSS-COUNTRY · WORLD JUSTICE PROJECT · RULE OF LAW INDEX, PUBLISHED ANNUALLY, DISTINCT FAMILY · DEPARTMENT OF ADMINISTRATIVE REFORMS · GOOD GOVERNANCE INDEX AND GOOD GOVERNANCE DAY · MINISTRY OF PANCHAYATI RAJ

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
WORLD BANK → Worldwide Governance Indicators, six dimensions, cross-country	DEPARTMENT OF ADMINISTRATIVE REFORMS → Good Governance Index and Good Governance Day	WORLD BANK → Worldwide Governance Indicators, six dimensions, cross-country
WORLD JUSTICE PROJECT → Rule of Law Index, published annually, distinct family	MINISTRY OF PANCHAYATI RAJ → Devolution Index, panchayat scope only	WORLD JUSTICE PROJECT → Rule of Law Index, published annually, distinct family

CORE CLAIM
- WORLD BANK → Worldwide Governance Indicators, six dimensions, cross-country
- WORLD JUSTICE PROJECT → Rule of Law Index, published annually, distinct family

MECHANISM
- DEPARTMENT OF ADMINISTRATIVE REFORMS → Good Governance Index and Good Governance Day
- MINISTRY OF PANCHAYATI RAJ → Devolution Index, panchayat scope only

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- WORLD BANK → Worldwide Governance Indicators, six dimensions, cross-country
- WORLD JUSTICE PROJECT → Rule of Law Index, published annually, distinct family

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: WORLD JUSTICE PROJECT → Rule of Law Index, published annually, distinct family.

06 STAGE 06 — FOUR OBJECTS AT FOUR SCALES

FOUR OBJECTS AT FOUR SCALES · WORLDWIDE GOVERNANCE INDICATORS BENCHMARK OVER TIME · STATE SECTORAL · GOOD GOVERNANCE INDEX, TEN SECTORS, COMPARISON CATEGORIES · SERVICE PORTAL · NATIONAL E-GOVERNANCE SERVICE DELIVERY ASSESSMENT, END-SERVICE DEPTH · DEVOLUTION INDEX; URBAN LOCAL BODIES ARE OUTSIDE ITS SCOPE

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
CROSS-COUNTRY → Worldwide Governance Indicators benchmark over time	SERVICE PORTAL → National e-Governance Service Delivery Assessment, end-service depth	CROSS-COUNTRY → Worldwide Governance Indicators benchmark over time
STATE SECTORAL → Good Governance Index, ten sectors, comparison categories	PANCHAYAT → Devolution Index; urban local bodies are outside its scope	STATE SECTORAL → Good Governance Index, ten sectors, comparison categories

CORE CLAIM
- CROSS-COUNTRY → Worldwide Governance Indicators benchmark over time
- STATE SECTORAL → Good Governance Index, ten sectors, comparison categories

MECHANISM
- SERVICE PORTAL → National e-Governance Service Delivery Assessment, end-service depth
- PANCHAYAT → Devolution Index; urban local bodies are outside its scope

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- CROSS-COUNTRY → Worldwide Governance Indicators benchmark over time
- STATE SECTORAL → Good Governance Index, ten sectors, comparison categories

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: PANCHAYAT → Devolution Index; urban local bodies are outside its scope.

07 STAGE 07 — NORM TO INSTRUMENT, LEGALITY HALF

NORM TO INSTRUMENT, LEGALITY HALF · RULE OF LAW · ARTICLE 14 NON-ARBITRARINESS AND REASONED ORDERS; UNEVEN BELOW THE · RIGHT TO INFORMATION ACT, 2005, SECTION 4 PROACTIVE DISCLOSURE · COMPTROLLER AND AUDITOR GENERAL, ARTICLES 148 TO 151; AUDIT · LOKPAL ACT, 2013 AND CENTRAL VIGILANCE COMMISSION ACT, 2003

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
RULE OF LAW → Article 14 non-arbitrariness and reasoned orders; uneven below the regulator tier	ACCOUNTABILITY → Comptroller and Auditor General, Articles 148 to 151; audit remedy	RULE OF LAW → Article 14 non-arbitrariness and reasoned orders; uneven below the regulator tier
TRANSPARENCY → Right to Information Act, 2005, Section 4 proactive disclosure; unaudited compliance	ACCOUNTABILITY → Lokpal Act, 2013 and Central Vigilance Commission Act, 2003; distinct remedies	TRANSPARENCY → Right to Information Act, 2005, Section 4 proactive disclosure; unaudited compliance

CORE CLAIM
- RULE OF LAW → Article 14 non-arbitrariness and reasoned orders; uneven below the regulator tier
- TRANSPARENCY → Right to Information Act, 2005, Section 4 proactive disclosure; unaudited compliance

MECHANISM
- ACCOUNTABILITY → Comptroller and Auditor General, Articles 148 to 151; audit remedy
- ACCOUNTABILITY → Lokpal Act, 2013 and Central Vigilance Commission Act, 2003; distinct remedies

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- RULE OF LAW → Article 14 non-arbitrariness and reasoned orders; uneven below the regulator tier
- TRANSPARENCY → Right to Information Act, 2005, Section 4 proactive disclosure; unaudited compliance

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE OF LAW → Article 14 non-arbitrariness and reasoned orders; uneven below the regulator tier.

08 STAGE 08 — NORM TO INSTRUMENT, DELIVERY HALF

NORM TO INSTRUMENT, DELIVERY HALF · SECTION 17 GRAM SABHA SOCIAL AUDIT; PRE-LEGISLATIVE CONSULTATION POLICY · STATE RIGHT-TO-SERVICE ACTS FROM MADHYA PRADESH, 2010; NOTIFIED SERVICES · GRIEVANCE PORTAL TWENTY-ONE-DAY BENCHMARK, DEPARTMENTAL GUIDELINES AUGUST 2024 · EQUITY AND EFFECTIVENESS · DIRECT BENEFIT TRANSFER TARGETING; OUTPUT-OUTCOME MONITORING FRAMEWORK

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
PARTICIPATION → Section 17 Gram Sabha social audit; Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy, 2014	RESPONSIVENESS → grievance portal twenty-one-day benchmark, departmental guidelines August 2024	PARTICIPATION → Section 17 Gram Sabha social audit; Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy, 2014
RESPONSIVENESS → state right-to-service Acts from Madhya Pradesh, 2010; notified services only	EQUITY AND EFFECTIVENESS → direct benefit transfer targeting; Output-Outcome Monitoring Framework	RESPONSIVENESS → state right-to-service Acts from Madhya Pradesh, 2010; notified services only

CORE CLAIM
- PARTICIPATION → Section 17 Gram Sabha social audit; Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy, 2014
- RESPONSIVENESS → state right-to-service Acts from Madhya Pradesh, 2010; notified services only

MECHANISM
- RESPONSIVENESS → grievance portal twenty-one-day benchmark, departmental guidelines August 2024
- EQUITY AND EFFECTIVENESS → direct benefit transfer targeting; Output-Outcome Monitoring Framework

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- PARTICIPATION → Section 17 Gram Sabha social audit; Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy, 2014
- RESPONSIVENESS → state right-to-service Acts from Madhya Pradesh, 2010; notified services only

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EQUITY AND EFFECTIVENESS → direct benefit transfer targeting; Output-Outcome Monitoring Framework.

09 STAGE 09 — SEVEN STAGES FROM NORM TO OUTCOME

SEVEN STAGES FROM NORM TO OUTCOME · LEGAL FORM · ACT, RULE, GUIDELINE OR EXECUTIVE POLICY, AND WHO IS · INSTITUTION AND PROCEDURE · IDENTIFIED DUTY-HOLDER, TIMELINE, OFFICER, APPEAL, PENALTY · CAPACITY AND CITIZEN SIDE · STAFF, RECORDS, BUDGET; AWARENESS, DISTANCE, COST, LANGUAGE · REMEDY AND FEEDBACK

LEGAL FORM → Act, rule, guideline or executive policy, and who is bound → INSTITUTION AND PROCEDURE → identified duty-holder, timeline, officer, appeal, penalty → CAPACITY AND CITIZEN SIDE → staff, records, budget; awareness, distance, cost, language → REMEDY AND FEEDBACK → is failure correctable, and is it counted and used for redesign → CLOSE DISTINCTION: Government is the formal authority structure, governance is the wider

CORE CLAIM
- LEGAL FORM → Act, rule, guideline or executive policy, and who is bound
- INSTITUTION AND PROCEDURE → identified duty-holder, timeline, officer, appeal, penalty

MECHANISM
- CAPACITY AND CITIZEN SIDE → staff, records, budget; awareness, distance, cost, language
- REMEDY AND FEEDBACK → is failure correctable, and is it counted and used for redesign

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Government is the formal authority structure, governance is the wider...
- LEGAL FORM → Act, rule, guideline or executive policy, and who is bound

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LEGAL FORM → Act, rule, guideline or executive policy, and who is bound.

10 STAGE 10 — FIVE INDEX TESTS

FIVE INDEX TESTS · INDICATOR VALIDITY · DOES IT MEASURE THE GOVERNED OUTCOME OR AN EASILY · IS THE DATA SELF-REPORTED BY THE ENTITY BEING RANKED · OUTPUT AGAINST OUTCOME · HOW MUCH OF THE SCORE IS COVERAGE RATHER THAN · ADJUSTMENT AND CONSEQUENCE · LIKE-FOR-LIKE FEDERAL COMPARISON; DOES A POOR SCORE TRIGGER CORRECTION

INDICATOR VALIDITY → does it measure the governed outcome or an easily counted input → COMPARABILITY → is the data self-reported by the entity being ranked → OUTPUT AGAINST OUTCOME → how much of the score is coverage rather than realised change → ADJUSTMENT AND CONSEQUENCE → like-for-like federal comparison; does a poor score trigger correction → AUTHORITY / EVIDENCE / IMPLEMENTATION LIMIT: Use constitutional values, citizen charters

CORE CLAIM
- INDICATOR VALIDITY → does it measure the governed outcome or an easily counted input
- COMPARABILITY → is the data self-reported by the entity being ranked

MECHANISM
- OUTPUT AGAINST OUTCOME → how much of the score is coverage rather than realised change
- ADJUSTMENT AND CONSEQUENCE → like-for-like federal comparison; does a poor score trigger correction

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- AUTHORITY / EVIDENCE / IMPLEMENTATION LIMIT: Use constitutional values, citizen charters;...
- INDICATOR VALIDITY → does it measure the governed outcome or an easily counted input

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: AUTHORITY / EVIDENCE / IMPLEMENTATION LIMIT: Use constitutional values, citizen charters.

11 STAGE 11 — ANSWER SPINE AND ANSWERED OBJECTIONS

ANSWER SPINE AND ANSWERED OBJECTIONS · SEPARATE THE INSTITUTION SET, THE DECISION PROCESS AND THE · NORM TO NAMED INSTRUMENT TO MECHANISM TO STATED LIMITATION · FIVE INDEX TESTS; ANSWER VAGUENESS, MEASUREMENT, CONDITIONALITY AND CAPACITY · GRADED VERDICT WITH THE EDITION-DATED EVIDENCE AND THE CONDITION

OPEN → separate the institution set, the decision process and the normative standard → BUILD → norm to named instrument to mechanism to stated limitation, three to six units → TEST → five index tests; answer vagueness, measurement, conditionality and capacity objections → CLOSE → graded verdict with the edition-dated evidence and the condition that would reverse it

CORE CLAIM
- OPEN → separate the institution set, the decision process and the normative standard
- BUILD → norm to named instrument to mechanism to stated limitation, three to six units

MECHANISM
- TEST → five index tests; answer vagueness, measurement, conditionality and capacity objections
- CLOSE → graded verdict with the edition-dated evidence and the condition that would reverse it

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- OPEN → separate the institution set, the decision process and the normative standard
- BUILD → norm to named instrument to mechanism to stated limitation, three to six units

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE → graded verdict with the edition-dated evidence and the condition that would reverse it.

E EXTRA — SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · INDICATOR CAPTURE · ADMINISTRATIVE EFFORT SHIFTS TOWARD IMPROVING THE MEASURED PROXY · PERCEPTION-MEASUREMENT GAP · WGI'S PERCEPTION BASIS MEANS A STATE CAN IMPROVE · FEDERAL COMPARABILITY PROBLEM · GGI'S EDITION-SPECIFIC GROUPING · DARPG FUNCTIONS AS BOTH THE NODAL REFORM DEPARTMENT (ARC

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH
- CAUTION: Indicator capture: administrative effort shifts toward improving the measured proxy
- CAUTION: Perception-measurement gap: WGI's perception basis means a state can improve
- CAUTION: Federal comparability problem: GGI's edition-specific grouping
- DARPG functions as both the nodal reform department (ARC follow-up, Sevottam,

ADVANCED DEBATE
- 2nd ARC's 15 reports operationalise the normative "good governance" standard into
- CAUTION: The absence of a single statutory "Good Governance Act" in India means the standard is
- CAUTION: A state can score well on GGI's "economic governance" sector through ease-of-business
- CAUTION: Comparing WGI's "Government Effectiveness" dimension with India's own e-governance/DPI

LEGACY / NUANCE
- CAUTION: Boundary case: an authoritarian-leaning but highly efficient administrative unit could
- CAUTION: Composite indices trade descriptive richness for comparability; over-reliance on GGI
- CAUTION: Normative frameworks (UNDP, ARC) resist gaming but offer no ready metric for tracking
- CAUTION: India's federal structure means Union-level frameworks (GGI, DARPG reform) can diagnose

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels